

Miner Hardballers Getting Cohesive, Ready For Wac

Andy Cohen's U.T.-El Paso baseball squad is gathering momentum.

And the veteran diamond coach is hoping it carries right into April when the Western Athletic Conference action opens.

UTEP split a four game series with Texas Tech last weekend. The series concluded Saturday with UTEP taking the first half of a doubleheader 6-1 behind the four-hit pitching of Dan Modlinski and a three-run homer by Glenn Villareal while the Red Raiders grabbed a 5-0 decision in the nightcap.

"MODLINSKI pitched a very good game in the opener," Cohen stated. "It's just like I have said before, pitching is going to have to carry us.

"It was so cold there that I think (Ron) Wrobel did not get warmed up at all for that second game. He hung in there well."

Art Bravo, Joe Pennies, Dau and Alan Morris were the top hitters for the Miners in the four game set.

"WE'RE GETTING to be a cohesive unit now," Cohen added. "The kids are getting to know each other's style. Our defense is going to have to hang in there if we are to do anything. We made some bad errors in Lubbock, but if we stick with it the defense will come around.

"I honestly believe that we are just about ready for the opening of conference play."

The Miners, 7-4, will have an open week with no games on tap.